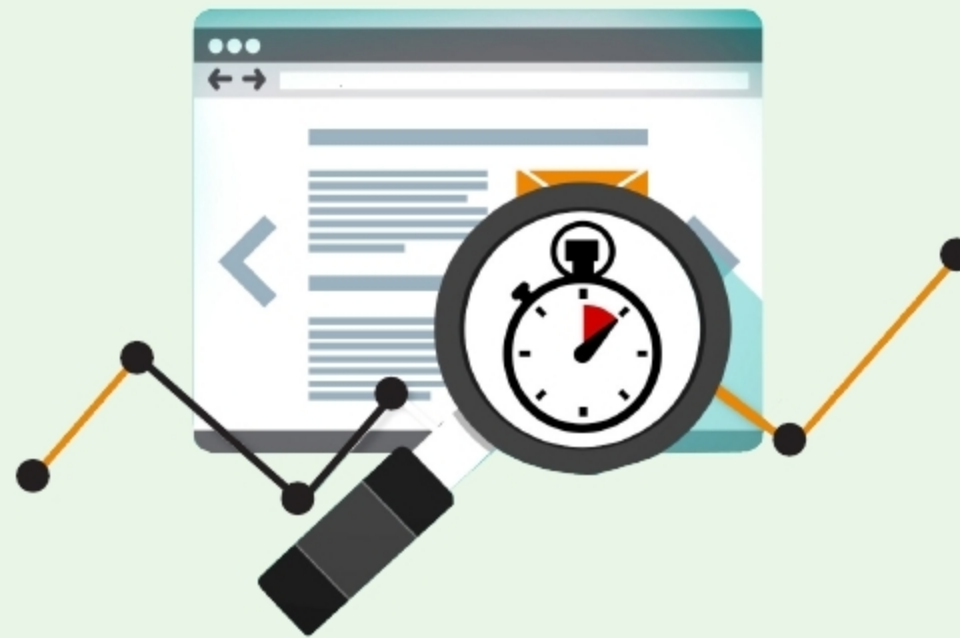


The Best Tools to Improve Web Performance



Any business that has a website aims for high-performance Web content delivery. The consequences of a sluggish, poorly performing website or application may cause tremendous losses to the organisation. Web optimisation addresses this issue, and this article features some of the best open source optimisation tools available.

The performance of websites and website applications has a huge impact on businesses that are dependent on them, day-in day-out. Sometimes these performance bottlenecks result in huge losses to the business or bring them to a standstill. It is good practice for any engineering team in an organisation to carry out regular performance checks (testing at a regular interval). They have to foresee challenges like scalability, well in advance.

For this purpose, one needs a good performance measurement tool or toolset. There are plenty of these available in this field. I will, however, describe a few important and popular open source tools.

There are various steps that can be taken to optimise or improve Web application performance. The following are some of the well-known and much used measures:

1) Cleaning up of the HTML document on a regular basis for unwanted clutter.

- 2) Always making sure that CSS performance is at an optimised level. This helps to a great extent.
- 3) Reducing the use of unwanted tags

- in the code as much as possible and minimising CSS, JS, HTML, etc.
- 4) Reducing external HTTP requests as much as possible. This prevents a

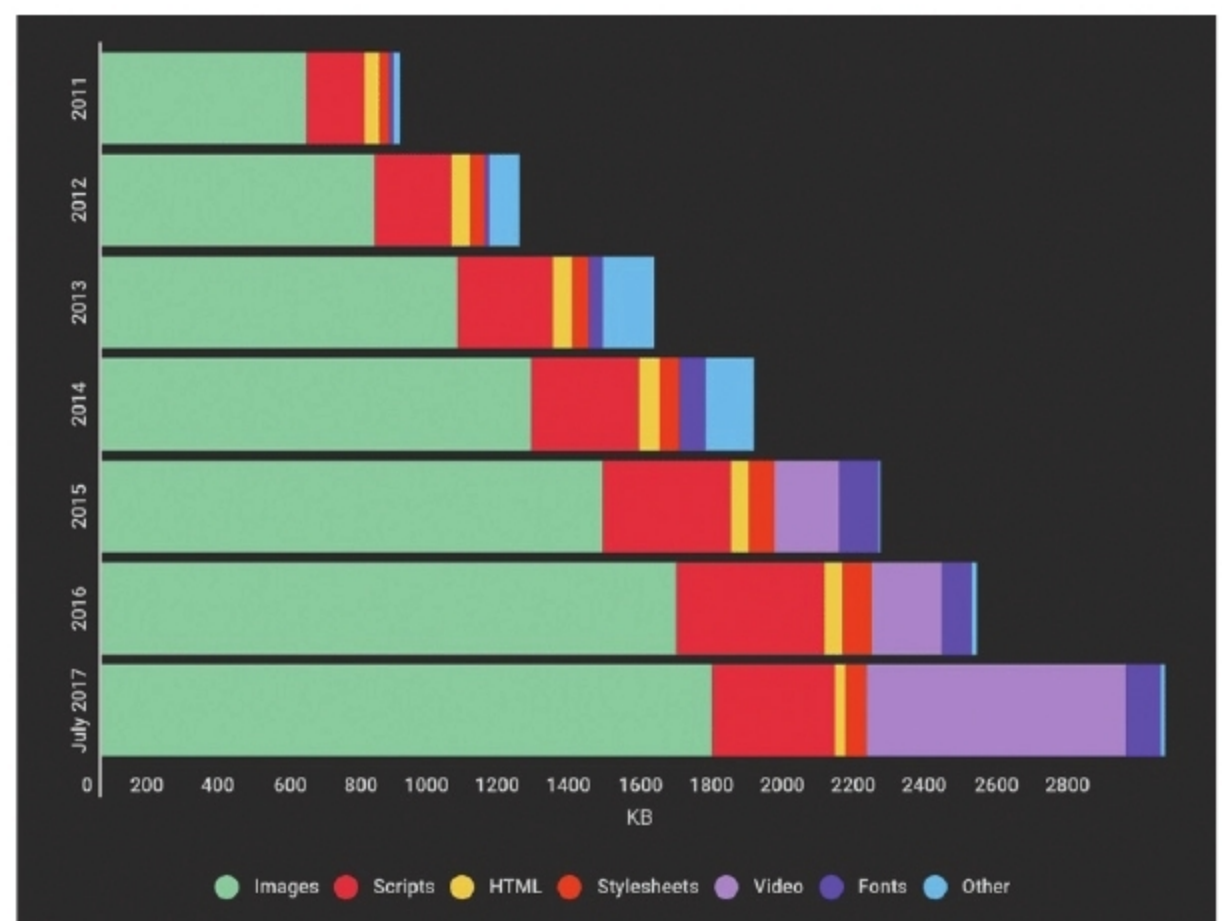


Figure 1: Growth of Web pages of different content types
(Source: <https://speedcurve.com/blog/web-performance-page-bloat/>)